StoryCast
Research and Documentation

Figma sitemap: click here

Figma wireframes: click here

Figma high-fidelity mockups: click here

1. Project overview

StoryCast is an accessible microsite for video and audio storytelling. It helps people discover meaningful stories and experience them in more than one way: by watching, listening or reading. The site has three main pages and one shared story page. It is built with plain HTML, Sass compiled to CSS, and a small amount of vanilla JavaScript. It uses no frameworks.

Page	Purpose
Home `index.html`	Introduces StoryCast with the heading “Every voice has a story.”, shows three featured stories, and links to the full collection.
All Stories `stories.html`	Lists every story as a card with a thumbnail, title, category, description and details. Pagination (six stories per page) appears when there are more than six stories.
Story Detail `story/my-story.html`	One shared template for every story. It loads the selected story from the address (`?id=story1` to `story5`) and shows the video, captions, audio version, timestamped transcript, credits and three related stories.
About StoryCast `about.html`	Explains the story behind StoryCast, its mission, what it believes and its vision, and ends with an “Explore Stories” call to action.

2. Research

I used desk research instead of surveys or interviews. I looked at three kinds of sources:

- **Accessibility guidance.** I used the WCAG 2.1 AA success criteria as the standard, especially colour contrast, keyboard access, visible focus, captions and transcripts for video, reflow on small screens and heading structure. I also used the W3C guide “Making Audio and Video Media Accessible”.
- **Layout techniques.** I used the MDN documentation on CSS container queries and the Sass documentation on the `@use` module system.
- **Media sources.** The five stories are existing videos from HISTORY, Biography, BBC News Africa, FACTS and a music video. They are used as sample content for this student project and are credited on each story page.

What I learned

- People who cannot hear the media still need the story, so a video needs captions and a written transcript next to it.
- An audio version helps people who want to listen without watching, for example on a phone.
- Media should only play when the visitor chooses. Nothing should start by itself.
- Using one story template for every video keeps the pages consistent and avoids repeating the same HTML.

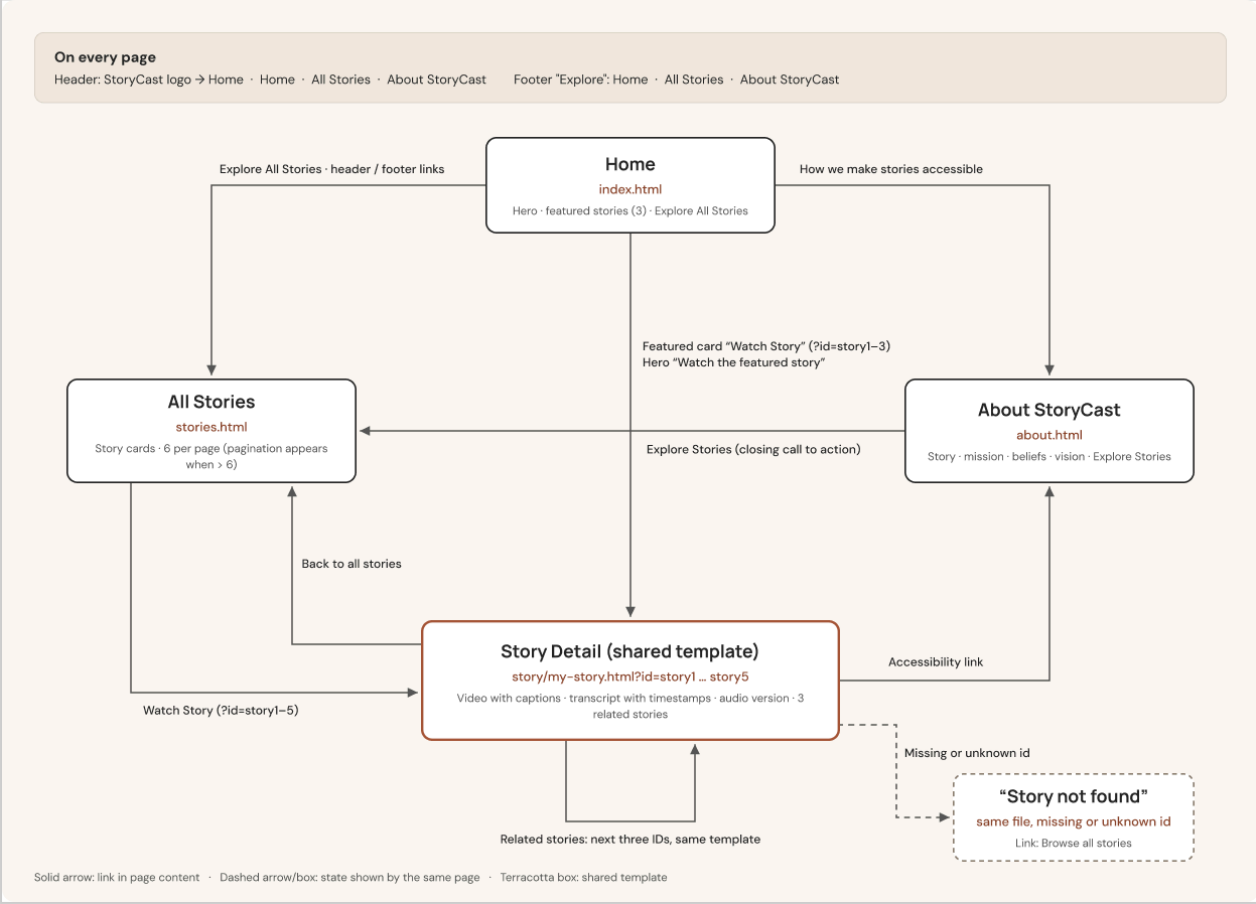
Assumed users

These are design assumptions, not interview results.

- A curious visitor who wants a short, meaningful story on a phone during a break.
- A deaf or hard-of-hearing visitor who needs captions and transcripts.
- A blind or low-vision visitor who uses a screen reader, keyboard or zoom and needs good structure and alt text.
- A student or teacher who wants to watch a story and read it closely.

3. Information architecture

Sitemap



Sitemap: Home links to All Stories, About and the featured stories. Every story opens in the same Story Detail template, which links to three related stories and back to All Stories.

Every page has the same header (logo, Home, All Stories, About StoryCast) and the same footer, which contains only an “Explore” section with Home, All Stories and About StoryCast.

Order of content

Page	Order of content
Home	Hero with the main heading and two buttons, featured video preview, three featured story cards, a call to action, and the footer.
All Stories	Page title and introduction, a status line (“Showing all 5 stories”), the story card grid, and the footer.
Story Detail	Breadcrumb, category, title, description and badges, video player with captions, audio version, transcript with timestamps, source and credits, three related stories, and the footer.
About StoryCast	Hero with photo, Our Story, Our Mission, What We Believe, Our Vision, the “Explore Stories” call to action, and the footer.

Navigation and labels

The site has three clear destinations in the header because it is small. Link text says where it goes, such as “Watch Story”, “Explore All Stories” and “Back to all stories”. A visitor can reach any story in two clicks from any page.

Content types

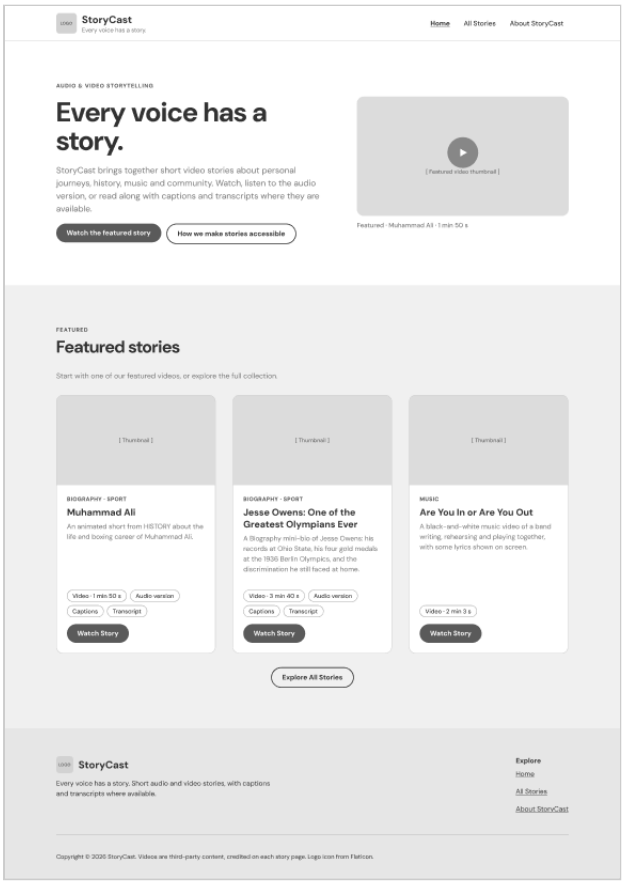
- Five video stories, each with a thumbnail taken from the video.
- Four of them also have a separate audio version (MP3).
- Three stories (Muhammad Ali, Jesse Owens and 57 Years Apart) have English captions and a timestamped transcript. The other two do not have them yet.

4. Design process and decisions

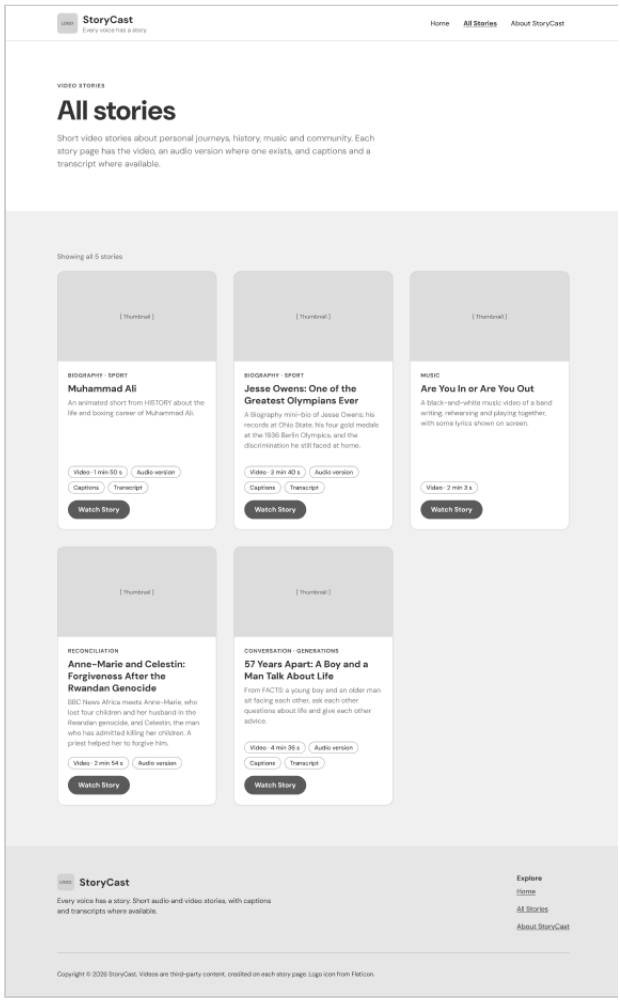
Wireframes and mockups. I planned the layouts first as grayscale wireframes in Figma, then built high-fidelity mockups for all four pages, at desktop (1440 px) and mobile (390 px) sizes. The Figma file also holds the sitemap, the design tokens and the reusable components (header, footer, buttons, story card, transcript panel, related-story item, video and audio players, pagination).

Wireframes

Home – Desktop

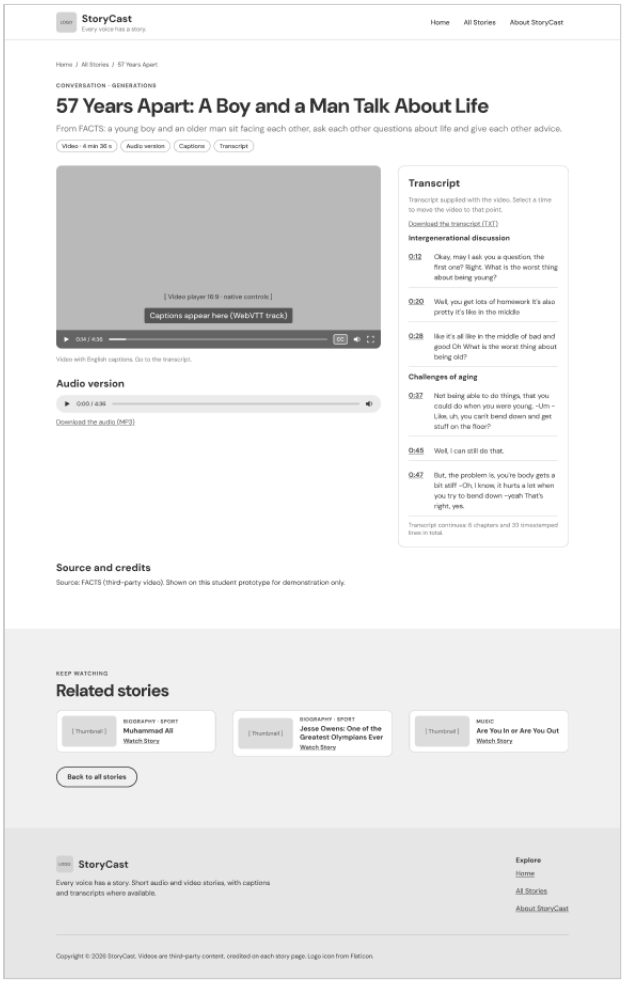


All Stories – Desktop

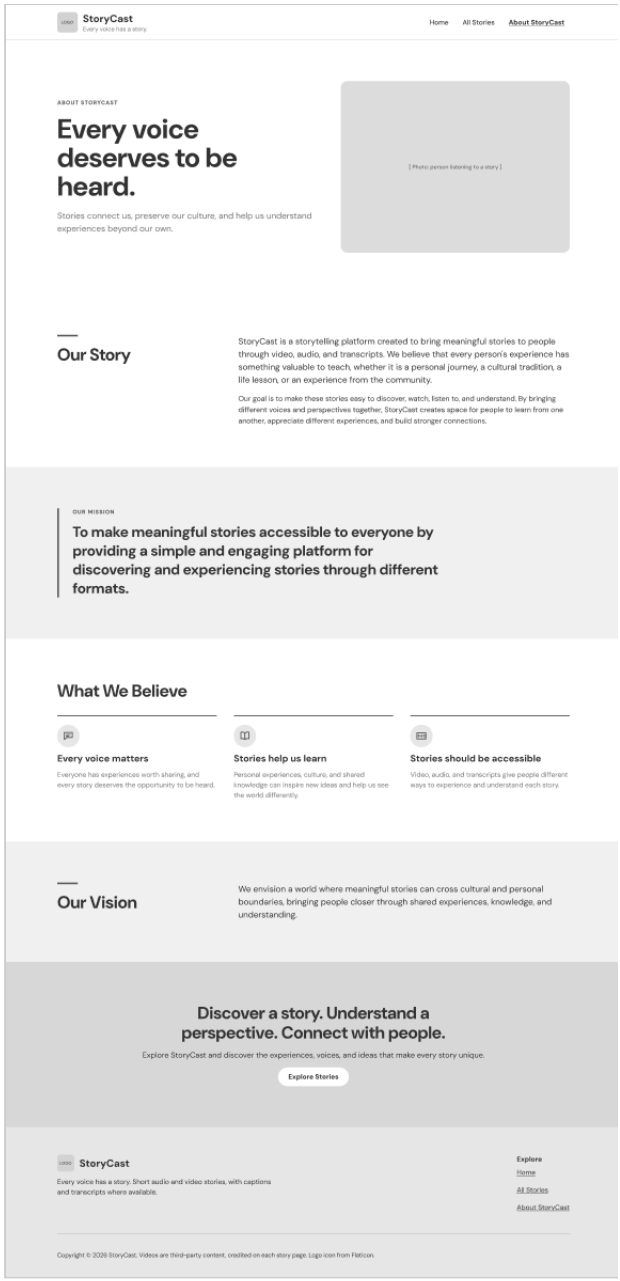


Desktop wireframes for Home and All Stories.

Story Detail – Desktop

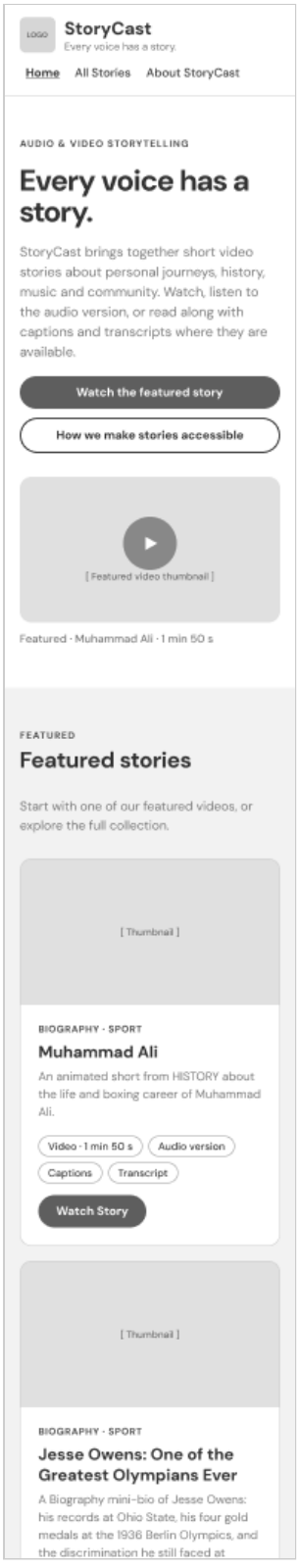


About StoryCast – Desktop

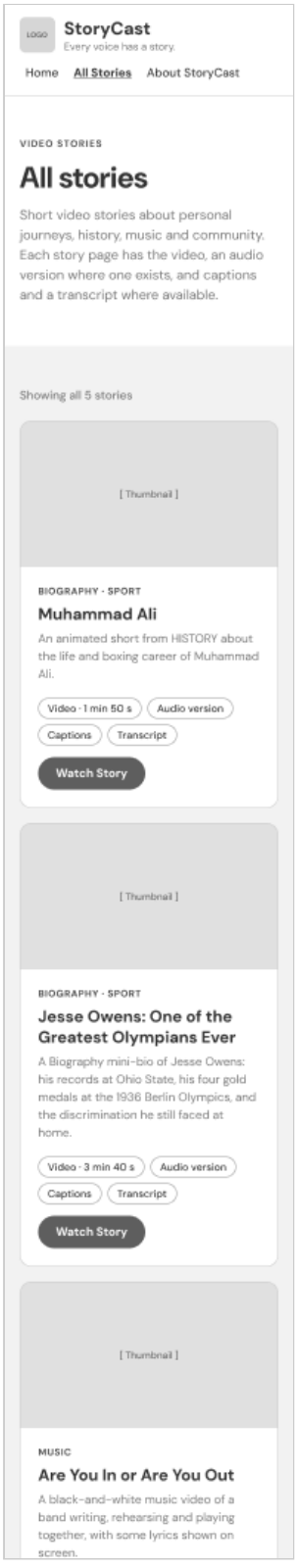


Desktop wireframes for Story Detail and About StoryCast.

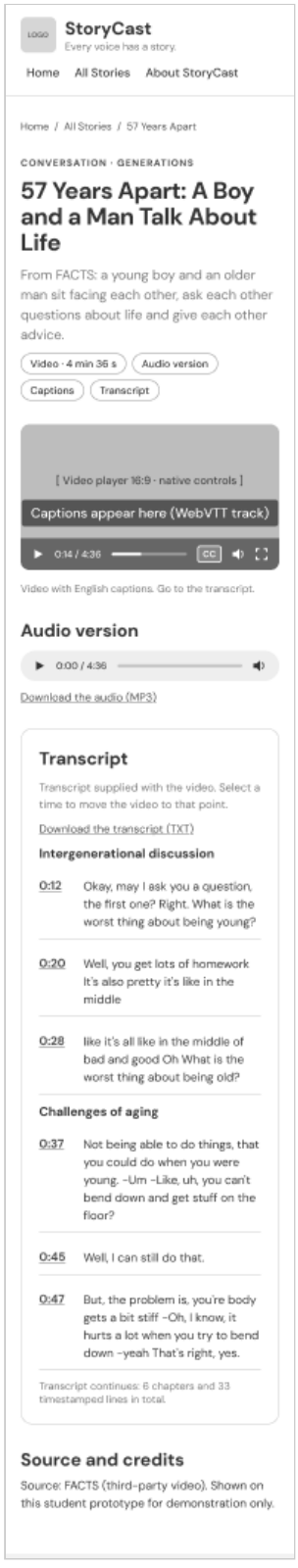
Home



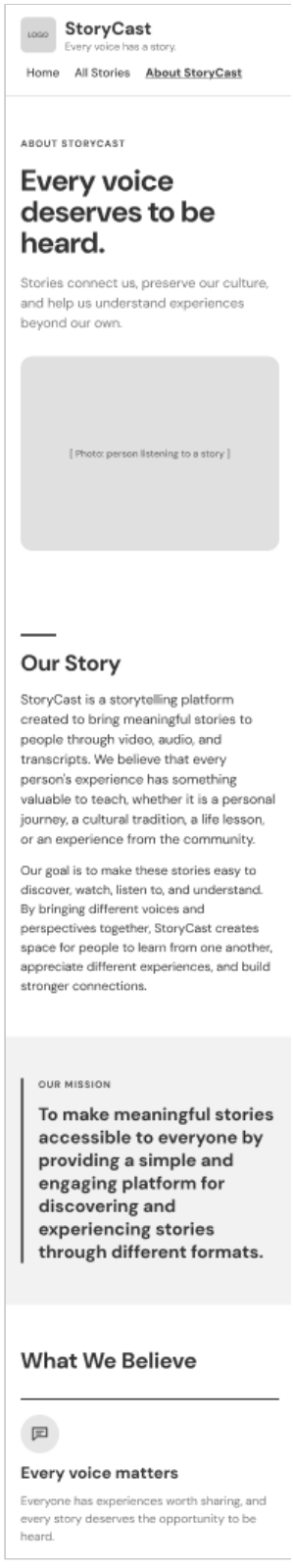
All Stories



Story Detail



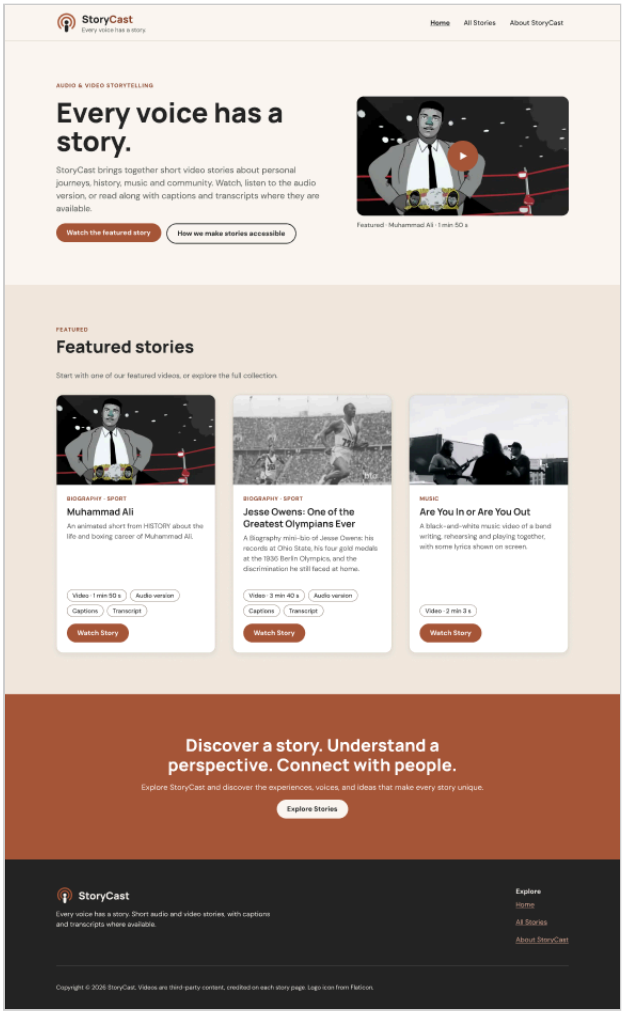
About



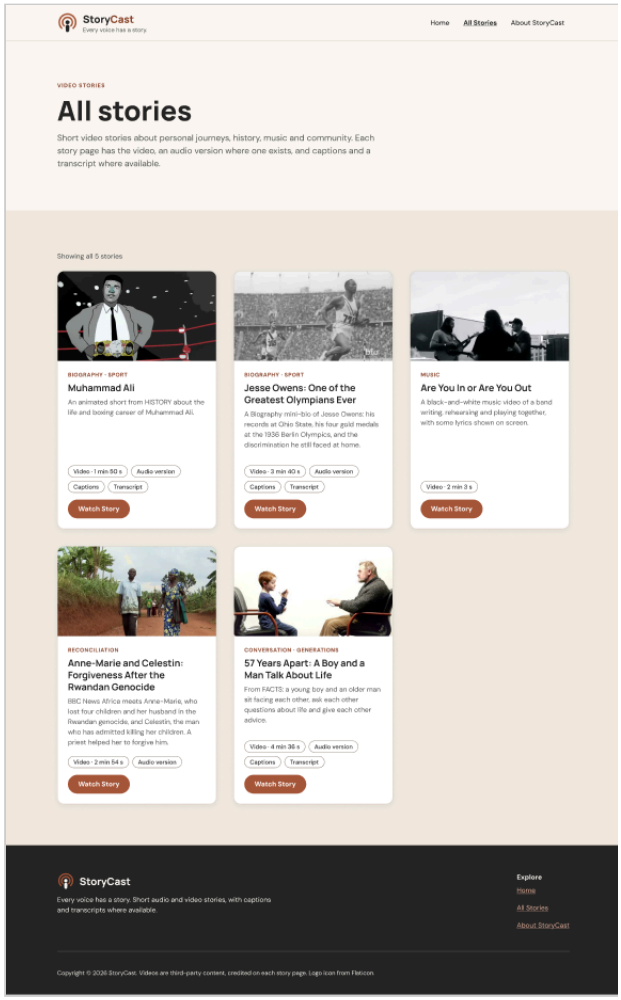
Mobile wireframes (top part of each page shown; full frames are in Figma).

High-fidelity mockups

Home – Desktop

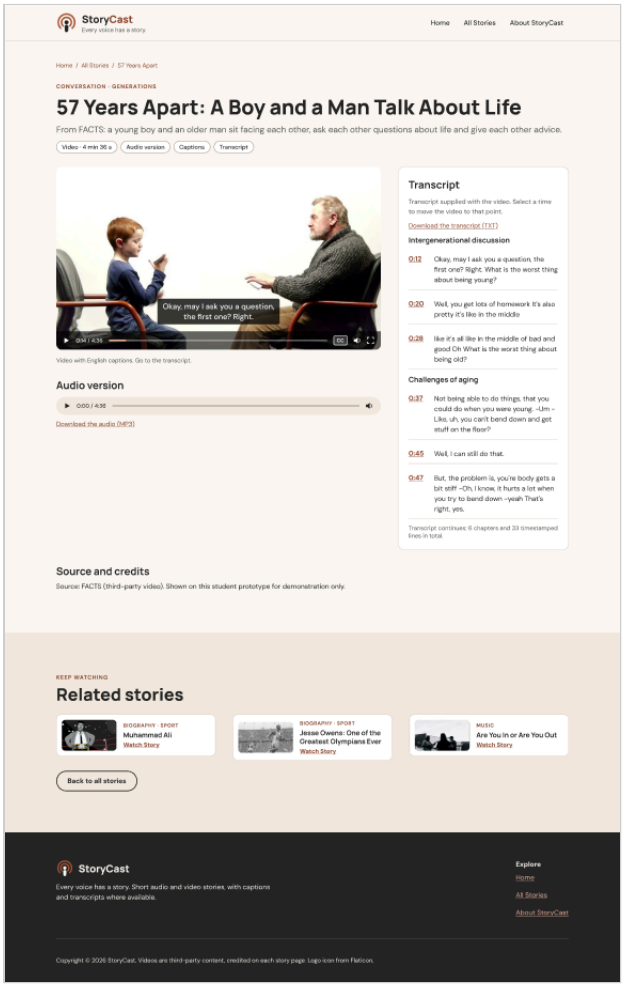


All Stories – Desktop

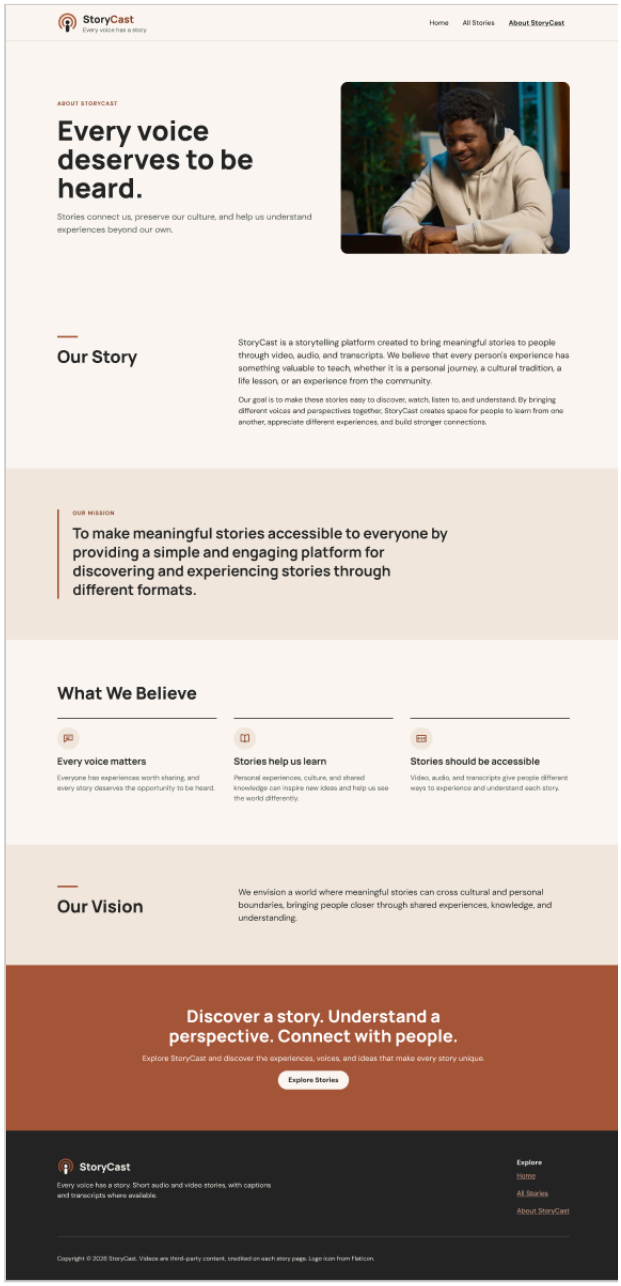


High-fidelity desktop mockups for Home and All Stories.

Story Detail – Desktop

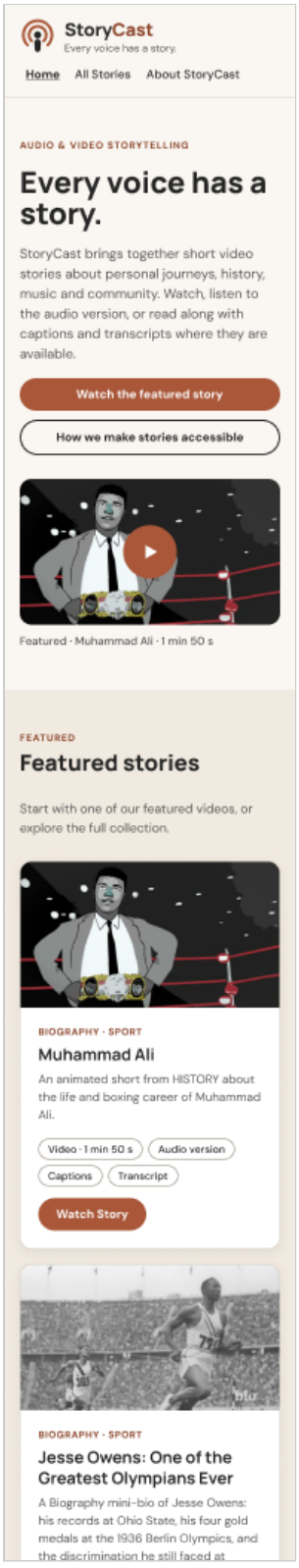


About StoryCast – Desktop

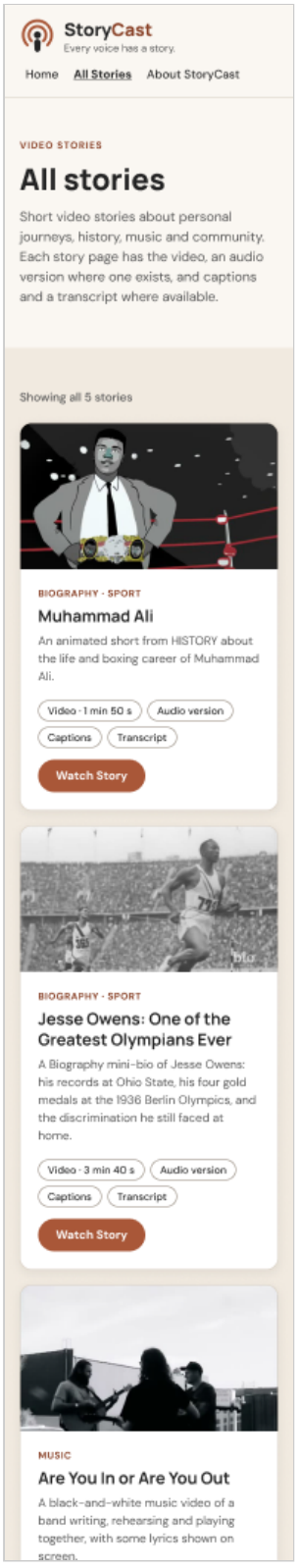


High-fidelity desktop mockups for Story Detail and About StoryCast.

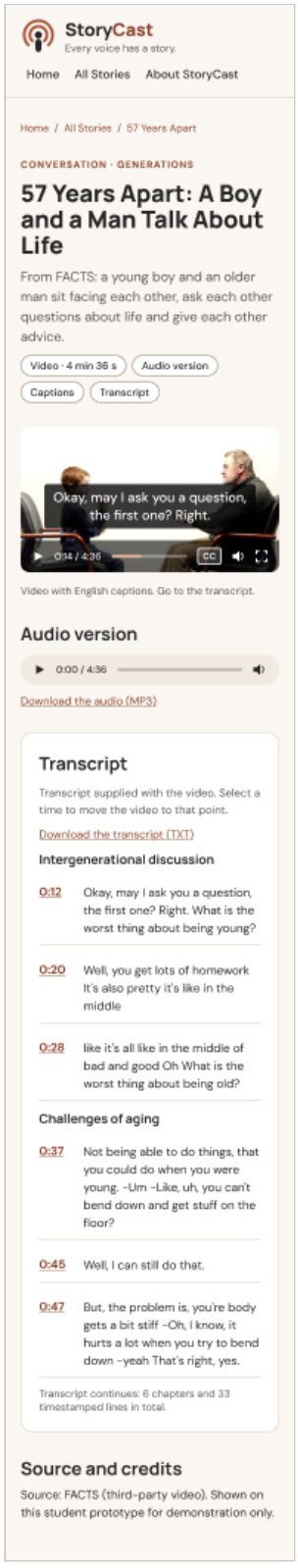
Home



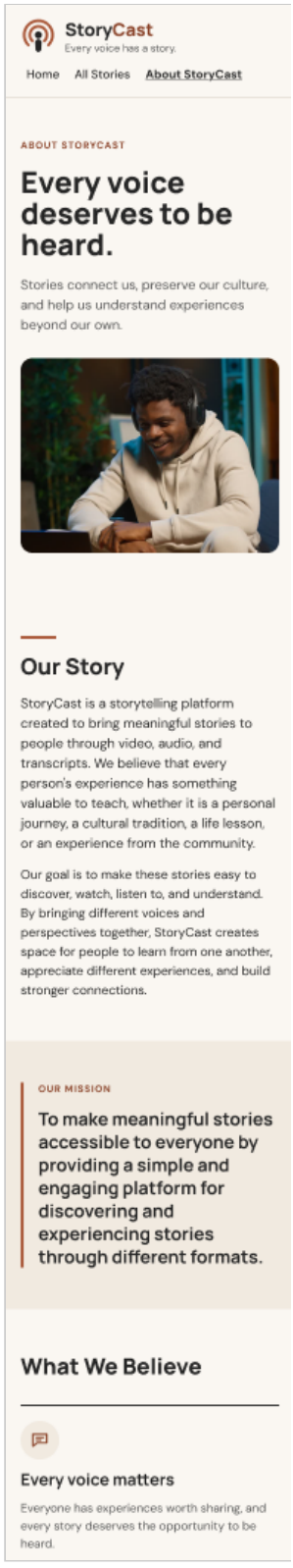
All Stories



Story Detail



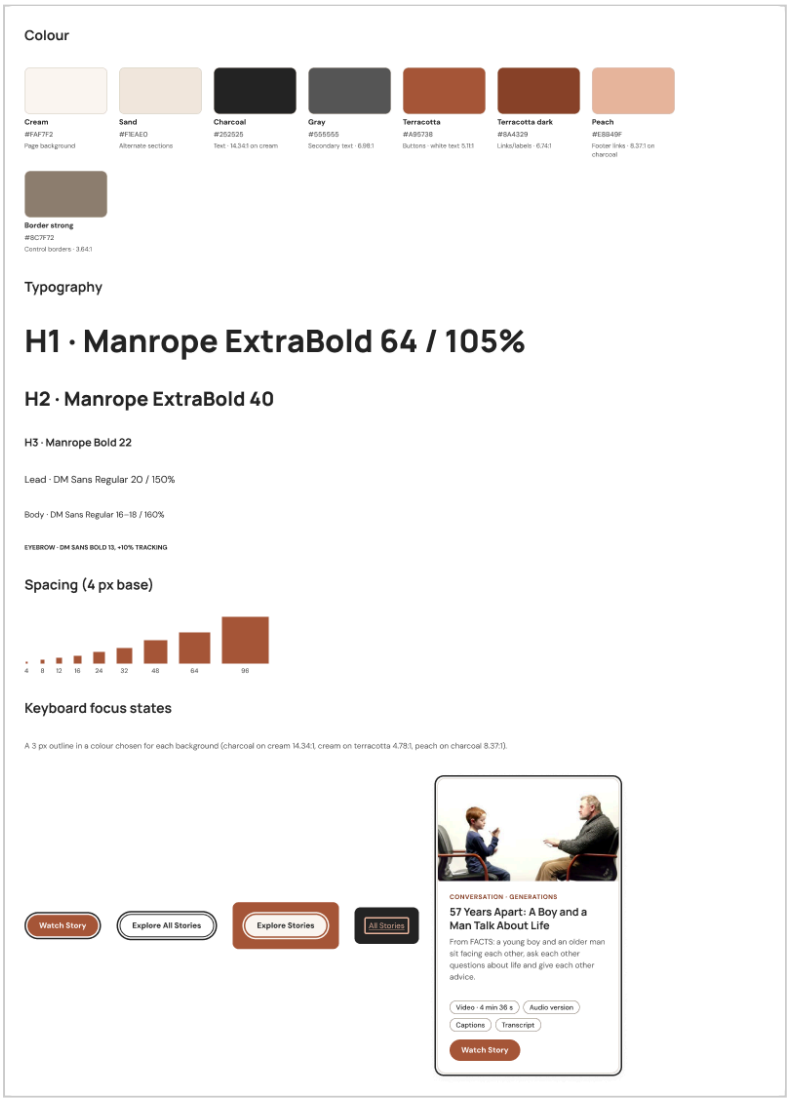
About



High-fidelity mobile mockups (top part of each page shown; full frames are in Figma).

Design tokens

Colours, type and spacing are defined once in Sass and reused everywhere.



Design tokens and keyboard focus states from the Figma file.

Token	Choice
Colours	Warm cream background (#FAF7F2), charcoal text (#252525), dark gray secondary text (#555555), terracotta accent (#A95738), a darker terracotta for links (#8A4329), a sand colour for alternate sections, and a charcoal footer with peach links.
Typography	Manrope for headings and DM Sans for body text. Body text is 16–18 px with a line height of 1.6.
Spacing and shape	A 4 px spacing scale (4 to 96 px), rounded corners (4, 8 and 16 px) and pill-shaped buttons.

Layout. I used CSS Grid for the page layouts and the story grid (one column on mobile, two on tablet, three on desktop), and Flexbox for the header, buttons, badges, card content and pagination.

Container query. The story card is the main responsive component. When its container is at least 34rem wide, the card shows the image beside the text; in narrower containers it stacks the image above the text.

5. Technical implementation

- **Semantic HTML.** Each page uses `header`, `nav`, `main`, `section`, `article`, `figure`, `figcaption` and `footer`. Each page has one `h1`, and heading levels do not skip.
- **Sass architecture.** Four token partials (`_colors`, `_typography`, `_spacing`, `_breakpoints`), then `_base`, `_layout`, `_components` and `_about`. `main.scss` loads them with `@use` and compiles to `css/main.css`.
- **BEM naming.** Class names follow block__element--modifier, such as `story-card__title` and `site-nav__link`.
- **JavaScript.** Three small files: `stories-data.js` holds the story details, `story-page.js` loads the selected story into the shared template, and `pagination.js` shows six stories per page on All Stories.
- **Media.** Videos use the native `<video>` element with a WebVTT `<track>` for captions. The audio version uses the native `<audio>` element. Each transcript timestamp is a button that moves the video to that point.

6. Accessibility

The site is designed toward WCAG 2.1 AA. The main measures are:

Area	What was done
Colour contrast	Body text on cream is 14.34:1, secondary text 6.98:1, links 6.74:1, white text on terracotta buttons 5.11:1 and footer links 8.37:1. All meet the 4.5:1 minimum for normal text.
Keyboard use	Every interactive element is a native link or button. The first tab stop on every page is a “Skip to main content” link.
Visible focus	A 3 px focus outline on every focusable element, in a colour chosen for each background (charcoal, cream or peach).
Captions and transcripts	Captions and a timestamped transcript for three of the five videos, shown in a transcript section on the story page with a TXT download. The page says clearly when they are not available yet.
Text alternatives	Story thumbnails and the About photo have descriptive alt text. The decorative logo and icons are hidden from screen readers.
ARIA, only where needed	`aria-current="page"` on the current navigation item and pagination button, and labels (`aria-label` or `aria-labelledby`) on the navigation areas.
Media behaviour	Nothing plays automatically. The native video and audio controls work with the keyboard.
Motion	Smooth scrolling and transitions are turned off when the visitor prefers reduced motion.

7. Testing

- **HTML:** all four pages passed the W3C Nu HTML Checker with 0 errors.
- **Keyboard:** I tabbed through every page with real key presses. Everything could be reached, there were no keyboard traps, and the focus outline was always visible.
- **Responsive:** I checked the pages at 320, 390, 800, 1024 and 1280 pixels wide. There was no horizontal scrolling.
- **Story page:** each story ID loaded the right video, audio, poster and transcript, and a wrong ID showed a “Story not found” message.
- **Still to do:** testing with a screen reader (VoiceOver or NVDA) and in browsers other than Chrome, and adding captions and transcripts for the last two videos.

8. Credits and licences

- **Videos:** HISTORY (“Drawn History: The Story of Muhammad Ali”), Biography (“Jesse Owens: One of the Greatest Olympians Ever”), BBC News Africa (Anne-Marie and Celestin), FACTS (“57 Years Apart”) and an unidentified music video. They are third-party content, used only as sample content in this student project and credited on each story page.
- **Thumbnails:** still frames taken from each video.
- **Logo:** recoloured from the free “Podcast” icon on Flaticon.
- **Fonts:** Google Fonts (Manrope and DM Sans).